last few months, foregoing numerous holidays, on the very important task of cleaning up bank balance sheets.

Nevertheless, a strong organization relies on continuous self-examination in order to stay at high levels of excellence. In the coming months, we will have the occasion to have a dialogue through town hall meetings. Let me, however, flag some areas of strength as well as those of concern.

EFFECTIVE SERVICE

We are a service organization. We have customers, whether they are the regulated organizations, the public, or the government. We need to serve them effectively and efficiently. By and large, our staff members perform well, with a few committed extraordinary individuals going way beyond the call of duty. Nevertheless, if I press the stakeholders I meet, I do hear criticisms. Our regulations are not always very clear, our staff sometimes is neither well informed about our own regulations nor willing to help the customer, our responses are occasionally extraordinarily slow and bureaucratic (in the sense of hiding behind opaque rules or avoiding a decision rather than taking a sensible course of action). The imagery that comes to mind for critics is of a traditional, unimaginative organization rather than a dynamic, intelligent one.

We are working on streamlining our regulations in the new master documents, and trying to weed out old historical ones. We need to continue to improve the language in them so that every concerned person can understand without much effort the letter and spirit of what we want to say. Simple-to-understand regulations will be a benefit to our staff also, especially those who are new to a department, because they can come up to speed quickly. We also need to build a library of cases that will help us understand how similar questions were dealt with in the past, that is, we need to build